



Return/Arrival Assistance

69,982+* | 1,119**

Assisted Voluntary return
of migrants to Nigeria



Protection to Vulnerable Groups

15,000+* | 195**

Targeted protection interventions to
vulnerable groups



Migration Governance

Activities conducted to support to
working group and partners.



Reintegration Assistance

54,000+* | 1,748**

Efforts to support sustainable re-
integration through services and
livelihoods



Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability & Learning

3,000+* | 291**

Systems to monitor progress and
ensure accountability



Protection in Emergencies

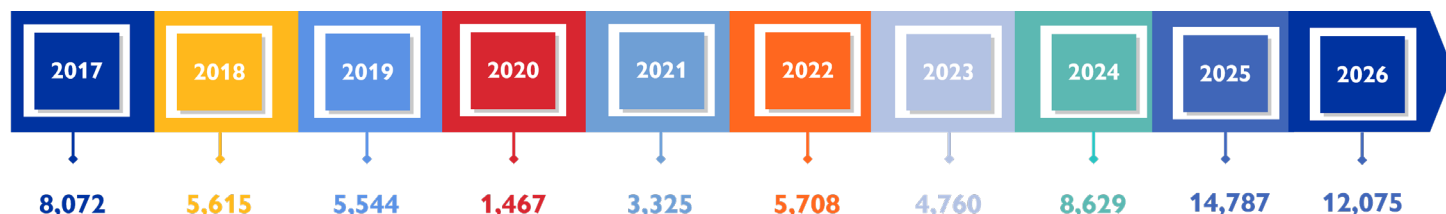
Rapid protection during displace-
ments, conflicts or disasters

*Total figures from 2017 to date
**Total Figures for August 2026

ASSISTED VOLUNTARY RETURNS AND REINTEGRATION 2017 - DATE

Over the past nine years, the International Organization for Migration (IOM), in partnership with the Federal Government of Nigeria (FGN), has facilitated the return of more than 69,000 Nigerians stranded in Libya, Niger, Mali and other countries in the region. Among them, over 54,000 individuals have received at least one form of socio-economic reintegration assistance tailored to their specific needs. This need-based reintegration assistance is designed to uphold the rights of migrants through individual and community-based interventions. These programmes have been implemented with the generous support of the European Union, the Kingdom of the Netherlands, the Government of Switzerland, the Government of Italy, the Government of Germany and the United Kingdom.

Returns Breakdown: 2017 - August 2026



69,982 Migrants Returned



23,951 (34%)
Women



32,637 (47%)
Men

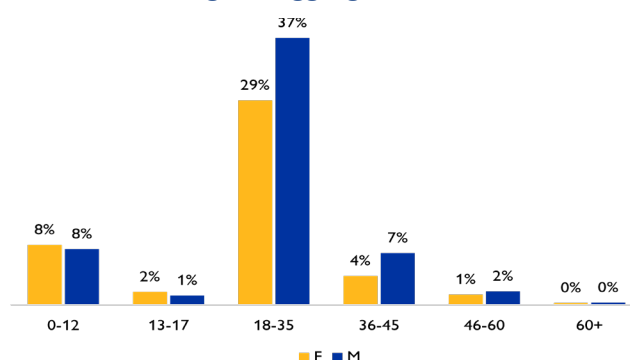


7,069 (10%)
Girls

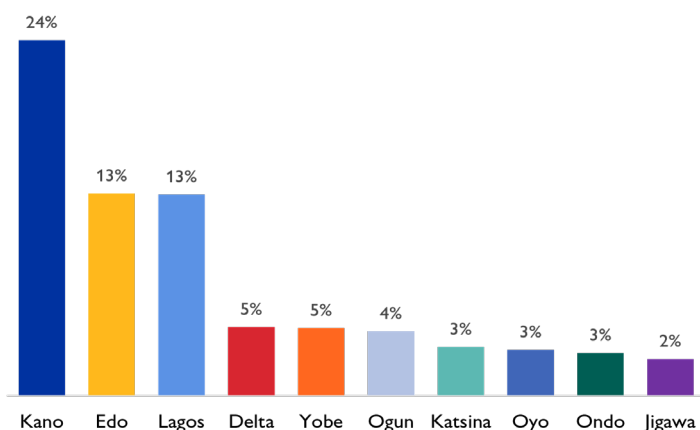


6,325 (9%)
Boys

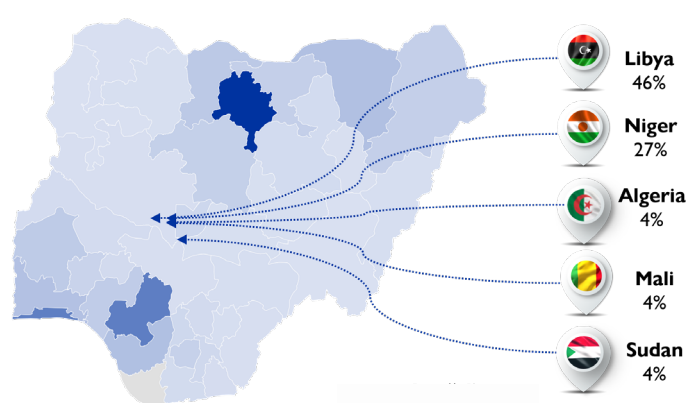
Age disaggregation



Top States of Return



Top Host or Transiting Countries



15,000+ Migrants in Vulnerable situations identified

7,898

Victims of Trafficking



627

Pregnant



3,793

Migrants with Health needs



539

Unaccompanied and Separated Children



2,469

Single Parents



1,621

Psychosocial support



Monthly Return Overview

AUGUST



2026



5
Charter Flights
Lagos - 3
Kano - 2



40
Commercial
Movements



0
Land/Bus
Movements

1,119 Migrants Returned



381 (34%)
Women



500 (45%)
Men

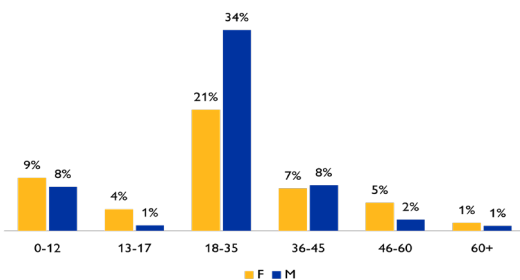


143 (13%)
Girls

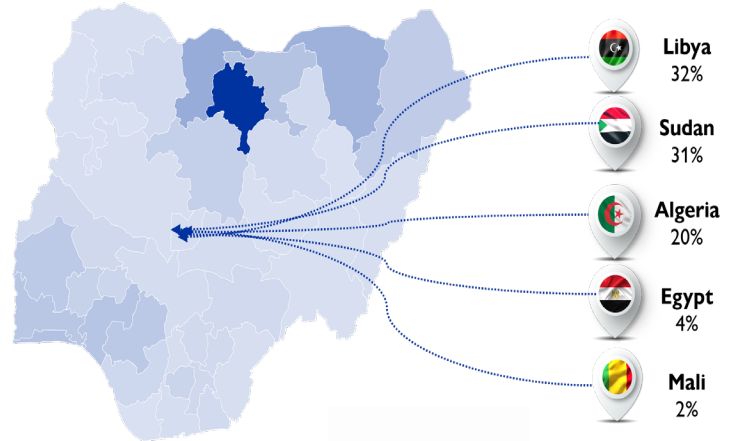


95 (8%)
Boys

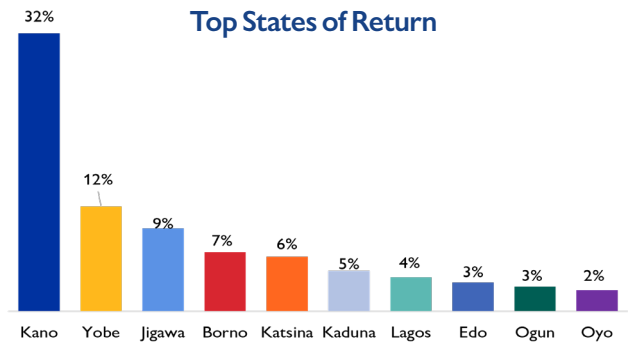
Age disaggregation



Top Host or Transiting Countries



Top States of Return



180+ Migrants in different Vulnerable situations identified



88
Victims of Trafficking



6
UASC & VOT



3
UASC



66
Migrants with
Health Needs



21
Single Parents

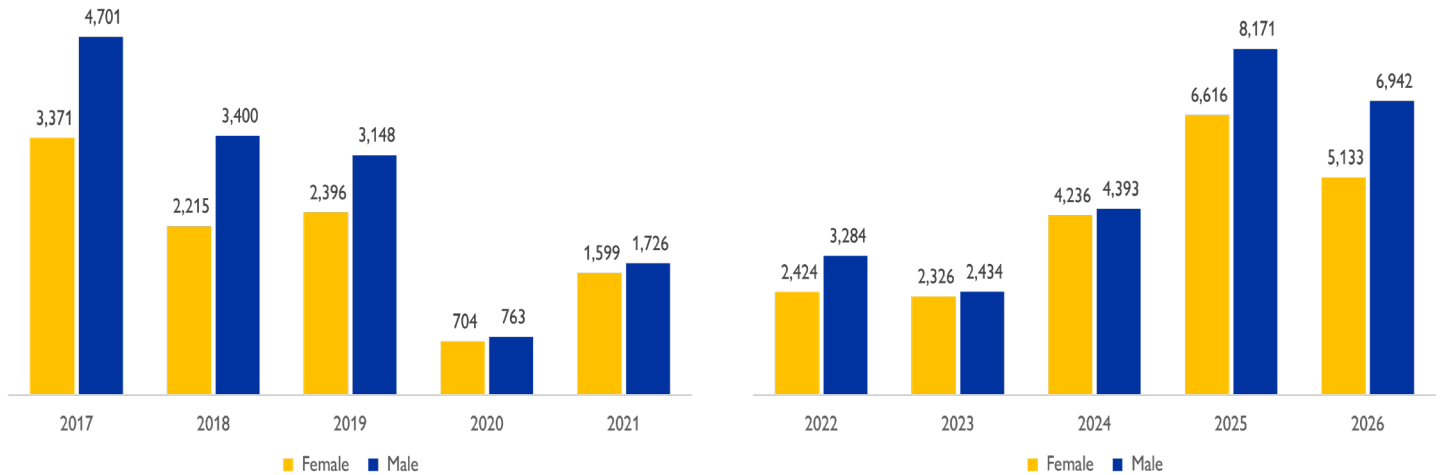


IOM staff assist passengers arriving on a charter flight at Murtala Muhammed International Airport, Lagos. Photo ©IOM Nigeria

MOBILITY TRENDS FROM INCEPTION TO DATE

Mobility trends based on movement records show fluctuating but generally increasing movements over the 2017–2026 period, with a sharp acceleration from 2022 onwards. A total of 69,982 movements were recorded between 2017 and August 2026. Annual movements were highest in 2025, with 14,787 individuals, followed by 2026, with 12,075 individuals already recorded by August 2026. Although 2026 figures cover only part of the year, they already represent approximately 82% of the 2025 annual total, indicating that mobility levels remain elevated. Earlier years show lower and more uneven movement patterns, declining from 8,072 in 2017 to 1,467 in 2020, before rising again from 3,325 in 2021 to 5,708 in 2022, 8,629 in 2024, and peaking in 2025.

Trend Analysis by Gender and Arrival year

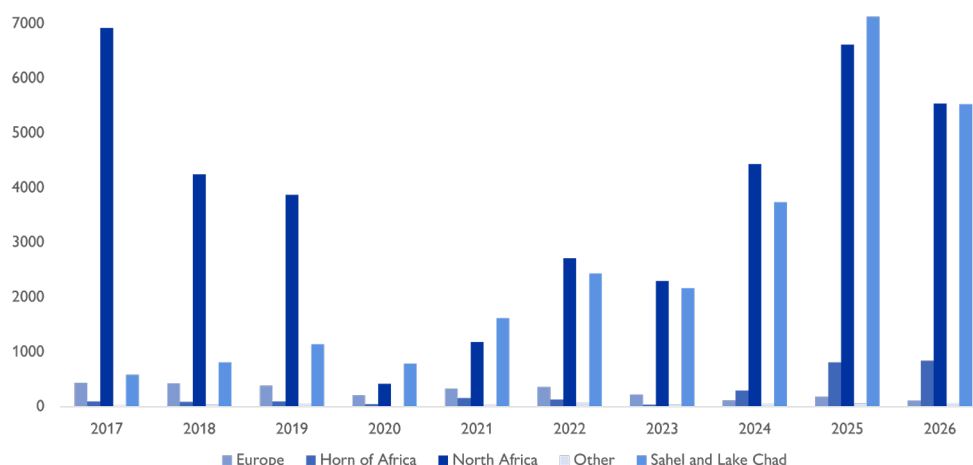


The first five years (2017–2021) recorded 24,023 movements, with the highest volume in 2017 (8,072) and a notable decline in 2020 (1,467), likely reflecting the disruption during the COVID-19 period. In comparison, the last five years (2022–2026) recorded 45,959 movements, representing approximately 66% of the overall 69,982 movements. This shows a substantial increase in movement volumes in the more recent period, with 2025 recording the highest annual figure (14,787) and 2026 already reaching 12,075. The data highlights a clear shift towards higher movement volumes in the past five years, with 2025 recording the highest level and 2026 maintaining this upward trend.

At the Regional Level, across the full 2017– August 2026 period, North Africa remained the largest overall corridor, accounting for 38,233 movements, equivalent to 55% of all recorded movements. The Sahel and Lake Chad followed with 25,935 movements (37%). While North Africa dominated earlier years, particularly in 2017 with 6,924 movements, the Sahel and Lake Chad corridor became increasingly prominent from 2021 onwards. Movements from the corridor rose from 1,620 in 2021 to 2,432 in 2022, 3,737 in 2024, and reached 7,128 in 2025, surpassing North Africa (6,615) that year. As at August 2026, both North Africa and the Sahel and Lake Chad movement corridors are equally leading, with 5,541 and 5,527 movements respectively.

The gender breakdown shows that mobility was consistently higher among males than females in most years. Between 2017 and August 2026, 38,962 males and 31,020 females were recorded, with males accounting for approximately 56% of total movements and females 44%. The highest number of male and female movements was recorded in 2025, with 8,171 males and 6,616 females, reflecting the overall peak in mobility that year.

Trend Analysis by Host Region



Overall, the data indicates that mobility trends have intensified significantly in recent years, particularly from 2024 onwards. The increase is largely concentrated along the North Africa and Sahel and Lake Chad corridors, with the latter becoming increasingly prominent in 2025 and 2026. While movements from Europe, the Horn of Africa, and other corridors remain present, their contribution is comparatively limited. The continued high volume recorded by August 2026 suggests that mobility pressures remain substantial.

POST ARRIVAL ASSISTANCE PROVIDED IN AUGUST 2026

In August 2026, IOM Nigeria provided post-arrival assistance to 1,058 (F: 503; M: 555) returned migrants under the Assisted Voluntary Return and Reintegration (AVRR) programme. Returnees from Libya (358), Sudan(350), Algeria(229), Egypt (48), Mali (23), Senegal (17), Tunisia(16) and other countries (17) were received and provided with post-arrival support. Returnees received immediate post arrival support, including accommodation, meals, medical screening and psychosocial support, before onward transportation to their communities of origin. These efforts were implemented in collaboration with government authorities and civil society partners to ensure the safe, dignified and orderly return of migrants and support their sustainable reintegration in Nigeria.

Onward Transportation Allowance

1,050 (497F; 553M) returned migrants were provided with transportation allowance to return to their final destinations.

Medical Support

179 (82F; 97M) received immediate medical support from the Transit Centre. **Two (2) returnees** were referred to the hospital for medical support during the reporting period.

Reintegration Orientation sessions

831 (367F; 464M) returnees participated in reintegration orientation sessions that provided an overview of the IOM reintegration process, available support services, timelines, and communication channels for accessing assistance.



Immediate Support

1,058 (503F; 555M) returned migrants received immediate support which includes a meal and non-food items (NFI) for their hygiene needs upon arrival.

Mental Health and Psychosocial Support

1,012 (487F; 525M) returnees in need of psychosocial assistance received support from the IOM PSS team and mentors upon arrival.

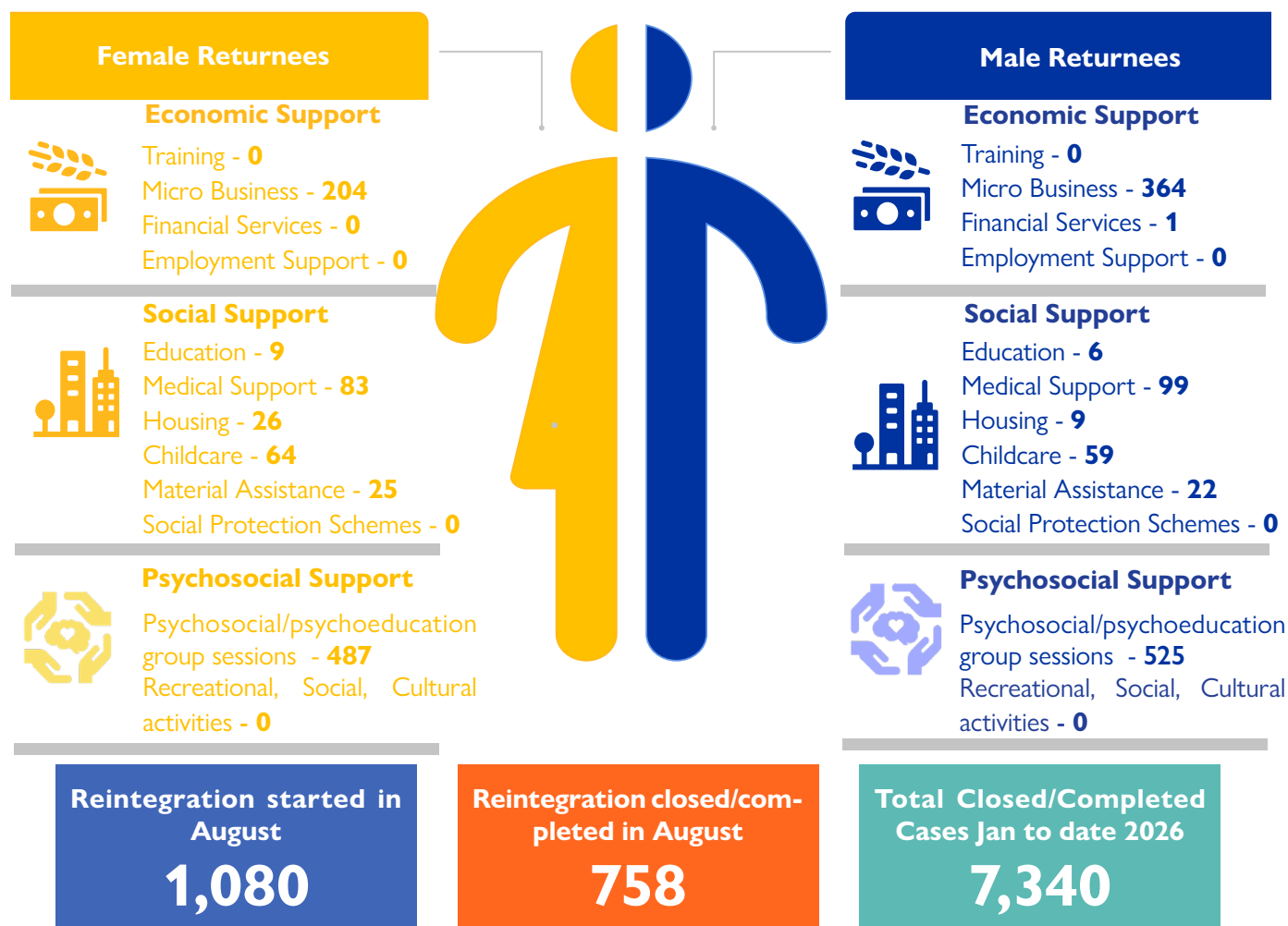
Temporary Accommodation

1,051 (500F; 551M) were accommodated in the Transit Centre in Lagos and in hotels in Kano, Abuja. The transit center is equipped to provide short term accommodation for returnees for a few days after arrival.



Migrants receive arrival assistance and support services upon arrival in Lagos, Nigeria, Photo ©IOM Nigeria

REINTEGRATION ASSISTANCE PROVIDED IN AUGUST 2026



Distribution of Livelihood Support Kits to Beneficiaries to support humanitarian response efforts in Gusau, Zamfara ©IOM Nigeria

ASSISTANCE TO VULNERABLE MIGRANTS

Vulnerable populations from rural areas, particularly in the southern regions, are often deceived or coerced into exploitative conditions in urban areas or across borders. Between January 2017 and August 2026, IOM facilitated the return of 7,898 Nigerian victims of trafficking, the majority of whom were adult females (83%). Notably, 93% of the victims identified were between 18 and 45 years of age. Victims of trafficking are provided with a range of protection and support services, including family tracing and reunification, vulnerability screening, risk assessment and shelter referrals.

Family Tracing

Family tracing and assessment were conducted for 7 unaccompanied migrant children(UMC) (2 boys and 5 girls) across Benue, Delta , Lagos and Kano States, resulting in the identification and assessment of family members and care arrangements to support informed best interest decisions.



Family Reunification

Family Reunification was conducted for Two (2) Female returnees requiring support for decision-making and care arrangements in Lagos and Delta State. Through the intervention, the migrant was safely reunified with their family or legal caregiver in accordance with established child protection standards and reunification procedures.

Risk Assessment

Conducted Risk assessment for 24 returnees from various mission to assess risk on return to Nigeria.

MENTAL HEALTH AND PSYCHOSOCIAL SUPPORT (MHPSS)

Peer Psychosocial Support

A total of **1,012** newly returned migrants (**487F; 525M**) were supported by IOM's psychosocial team and PSS mentors upon arrival, enhancing their capacity to identify and address psychological and social issues that impede sustainable reintegration.

Capacity Building for Returnees

A total of **15 (8F; 7M)** return migrants were reached with different MHPSS training, enhancing their capacity to identify, address their wellbeing needs and strengthen resilience to cope with reintegration challenges.



Referral To Clinical care

Eight (8) migrants (**6F;2M**) that returned with severe psychological health need for recommendation of specialized mental health care from IOM partners.

Family Support

Nine (9) families of returnees with mental health needs were reached with caregiver support to mitigate the burden of caregiving and improved caregivers' wellbeing.

 **11,000+**

Individuals participated in
Peace building initiatives in the
North West Region

 **300+**

Individuals supported in
Durable Solutions initiatives in
the North East Region

 **2000+**

Individuals supported in
Protection Based Activities in
the North Central Region

North West (Peace Building)

MHPSS Interventions

9,946 individuals (1,846 boys, 1,961 girls, 2,736 men and 3,403 women) received various psychosocial interventions, including counselling, Psychological First Aid (PFA), psychoeducation, GBV and counter-trafficking sensitization, focus group discussions, family and group support, recreational and art-based activities, and social and intergenerational activities, to foster unity and community healing.

Community-Based Activities

1,399 individuals (307 boys, 239 girls, 344 men and 509 women) participated in community-based cultural activities, including cultural attire shows and food festivals, rope games, cultural dances, and traditional food and drinks sharing, as part of reconciliation events in Dandume, Jibia, Kankara and Safana LGAs, respectively, to foster unity and community healing.

North East (Durable Solutions)

317 individuals (123 men and 194 women) were supported through a range of psychosocial interventions aimed at promoting individual well-being, strengthening social connections, and fostering unity and community healing. The interventions included individual and group counselling, Psychological First Aid (PFA), psychoeducation, family and group support, socio-relational and intergenerational activities, social skills development, focus group discussions (FGDs), and sensitization sessions on gender-based violence (GBV) and counter-trafficking (CT). Participants also engaged in recreational and creative activities, including games, sporting events, art-based activities, rituals and celebrations, and informal education, providing safe and inclusive opportunities for social interaction, emotional support, and community cohesion.

North Central (Protection)

CBT- Informed Interventions

Wave 1 of the CBT-informed intervention entered its final six weeks on Monday, 31 August 2026, reaching 576 individuals (288 men and 288 women) across the 12 operational LGAs. The intervention continued to provide structured psychosocial support aimed at strengthening coping mechanisms, promoting emotional well-being, and fostering community healing.

MHPSS Interventions

1,825 individuals (643 men and 1,182 women) received psychosocial support through counselling, PFA, psychoeducation, family and group support, GBV and CT sensitization, FGDs, socio-relational activities, and recreational and creative activities, including games, sports, art-based activities, and community celebrations, to promote well-being, unity, and community healing.



Participants engage in recreation activities during the MHPSS Community Outreach in Katsina. Photo ©IOM Nigeria



83%

Monitored Migrants had started and are operating their microbusinesses



61%

Monitored Migrants reported Business were operational at the time of monitoring



84%

of Monitored beneficiaries were satisfied with the Reintegration assistance

Reintegration Assistance (RA) Survey

RA surveys conducted in August 2026 under the MPRR-SSA project across 12 states, using 28 DTM enumerators, showed generally positive uptake and implementation of microbusiness support among beneficiaries. Of the respondents monitored, 83% had started their microbusiness activities using the reintegration assistance received, while 17% had not yet commenced. Business performance was also largely positive, with 61% reporting that their businesses were open and functioning well, while 20% were operational but not functioning well. However, 14% were yet to start or had only recently opened, and 5% reported that their businesses closure or other descriptions of business status, highlighting the need for continued monitoring and business development support.

Beneficiary satisfaction with the assistance was largely positive, with 43% satisfied and 41% very satisfied, representing a combined satisfaction level of 84%. However, 44% reported receiving assistance six months or more after return, underscoring the need to streamline assistance delivery and reduce delays that may affect timely economic recovery and sustainable reintegration. Continued follow-up is also recommended to address operational challenges and strengthen the viability and sustainability of supported businesses.

Complaints and Feedback Mechanism

During the reporting period, the Complaints and Feedback Mechanism (CFM) received approximately 120 feedback cases from beneficiaries, comprising complaints, positive feedback, information requests, and other enquiries related to programme implementation and service delivery. In addition, more than 500 calls were received through the toll-free line, dedicated CFM phone number, and WhatsApp platform, while email remained another channel for submitting complaints and enquiries. These channels continued to facilitate timely communication, address beneficiary concerns, and strengthen accountability.

The CFM team also conducted sensitization sessions at the transit centre to raise beneficiaries' awareness of available feedback channels and encourage their use. In parallel, staff were trained on the CFM, focusing on complaint-handling procedures, confidentiality and protection principles, timely response, and accountability to affected populations. These activities strengthened awareness and capacity to ensure that beneficiaries can safely and effectively raise concerns, seek information, and provide feedback.



Beneficiary Monitoring in South West, Nigeria Photo ©IOM Nigeria



Strengthen State Level Protection System

August data indicate continued arrivals of vulnerable migrants, including victims of trafficking (VoTs), unaccompanied and separated children (UASC) and individuals with medical and psychosocial needs. To address these vulnerabilities effectively, the Government should:

- Reinforce and operationalize protection referral pathways to ensure timely identification and response for VoTs and UASC.
- Guarantee the availability and accessibility of specialized services, including gender-based violence (GBV) response, child protection mechanisms and mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS), across all return states.
- Allocate dedicated resources and trained personnel within state structures to strengthen case management and ensure continuity of care for high-risk groups.

Strengthen Anti-Trafficking and Child Protection Response Systems

The increased identification of victims of trafficking (VoTs) and unaccompanied and separated children (UASC) underscores the urgent need for a more coordinated and robust protection framework. To address these gaps, the Government should:

- Enhance coordination with the National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons (NAPTIP) and state ministries to ensure timely referrals and joint case management for VoTs and UASC.
- Expand access to safe shelters and specialized care services, including psychosocial support and legal assistance, tailored to the needs of high-risk groups.
- Develop and implement standardized reintegration protocols to ensure continuity of care and long-term support for survivors of trafficking and vulnerable children.

Strengthen data sharing and migration governance coordination mechanisms

Effective migration governance requires timely, accurate data and strong inter-agency collaboration. To improve evidence-based decision-making and coordinated responses, the Government should:

- Establish formal data-sharing protocols between federal, state and partner agencies to ensure consistency, confidentiality and real-time access to migration-related information.
- Create an integrated migration data platform to consolidate information on returnees, protection cases and service delivery, enabling better planning and resource allocation.
- Convene regular coordination forums bringing together key stakeholders, including NAPTIP, state ministries and partners, to review trends, address gaps and harmonize interventions.

Enhance Co-Led Reception Management

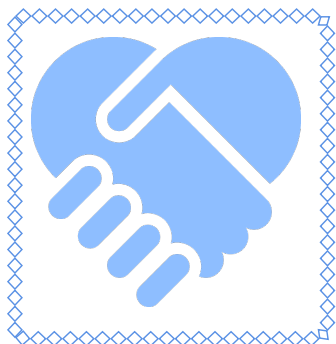
With more than 1,000 migrants supported upon arrival in August 2026, there is a critical need to strengthen government engagement in reception operations. To achieve this, the Government should:

- Increase staffing and presence at reception points to ensure timely assistance and reduce operational bottlenecks during peak arrivals.
- Institutionalize co-led coordination mechanisms between government agencies and partners to clarify roles, responsibilities and decision-making processes.
- Invest in infrastructure and logistics support at key reception hubs to improve service delivery and ensure dignified reception conditions.

Institutionalize Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS) in Social Welfare Systems

High psychosocial needs, with over 1,000 migrants supported upon arrival in August, underscore the urgency of integrating MHPSS into state-level social protection frameworks. To achieve this, the Government should:

- Embed MHPSS services within state ministries and frontline social welfare structures to ensure sustainable, system-wide access to care.
- Recruit and train dedicated MHPSS professionals to strengthen the capacity of social workers and case managers in addressing mental health needs.
- Allocate budgetary resources for MHPSS programming to guarantee continuity of services and reduce reliance on emergency or ad hoc interventions.



After approximately 14 years abroad, Mr. Bello Salim returned to Nigeria determined to rebuild his life and establish a sustainable livelihood. Having left Nigeria at 17, he lived in Libya before travelling to Europe, where he resided in Germany, Italy, France and Switzerland, pursued education, worked mainly in construction, and established a family. After unsuccessful efforts to regularize his residency status in Italy, he decided to return voluntarily to Nigeria.

His reintegration journey initially presented challenges, including difficulties communicating with his case manager and delays in accessing economic reintegration assistance. Despite these challenges, the support he received became a turning point in his economic recovery. He established his own business, which now serves as his primary source of income and has created employment for two young men—vocational skills and an apprentice gaining other as a paid employee.

From Return to Opportunity: Mr. Bello Salim's Reintegration

Mr. Salim believes his business has significant growth potential but requires additional working capital and inventory to expand its product range, attract more customers and strengthen its sustainability.

Reflecting on his migration experience, he described migration as “a valuable learning process that broadens perspectives and facilitates mutual exchange of knowledge and experiences.” He noted that the skills and perspectives gained abroad continue to shape his personal and professional development.

Mr. Salim's experience demonstrates the tangible impact of reintegration assistance: from returning after more than a decade abroad to establishing a functioning business, securing his livelihood, and creating employment opportunities for others. His story also highlights the importance of timely assistance and continued business support in strengthening sustainable reintegration outcomes.



A beneficiary operates a small business supported by IOM in Nigeria. Photo ©IOM Nigeria



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